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Computer Influence By End Of Century

People who could not adapt themselves to the change which would come about by the year 2000, when much of life would be determined by machines, would have a difficult time it was predicted in Christchurch yesterday.

This comment came from Dr R. W. Hamming, head of the department of computer science research at the Bell Telephone Laboratories in the United States.

In New Zealand to take part in the second annual conference of the New Zealand Computer Society, which begins in Dunedin this week, Dr Hamming spent yesterday lecturing on computers to the Canterbury Computer Society.

People who were displaced by the age of the computer would have to be looked after by society, Dr Hamming said.

But he emphasised that the future meant that with more freedom the individual would have to look more to himself for assistance and not always expect to be told what to do with his leisure time.

Dr Hamming said his work was in selecting what fields of knowledge should be explored.

The time had come for the engineer to become more humane and to apply the logic of his profession to the day-to-day lives of man in the widest sense.

"Computers will help us to do this but we must always remember that they are just a tool. They can do good or bad and the good or evil lies

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Press, Volume CX, Issue 32378, 18
August 1970, Page 18

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